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Experiential learning with Adaptive immerse Gamification: AI-Driven Virtual Reality for Skill Development and Personalized Learning in Education

Christina Gatsakou
Phd cand.
Department of Information and Communication Systems Engineering (ICSD) UOA
National Center for Scientific Research Demokritos Athens Greece
icsdd23013@icsd.aegean.gr

Athanasios Drigas
Net Media Lab & Mind & Brain R&D, Institute of Informatics & Telecommunications, National Centre of Scientific Research 'Demokritos', 153 41 Agia Paraskevi, Greece;
dr@iit.demokritos.gr

Charalabos Skianis
Department of Information & Communication Systems Engineering, University of the Aegean, 832 00 Karlovasi, Greece;
cskianis@aegean.gr

Nikolaos Bardis
Department of Mathematics and Engineering Sciences
Hellenic Army Academy, Vari, Greece
bardis@ieee.org

***Abstract*— The purpose of this article is to explore an innovative teaching approach through the integration of adaptive immersive gamification, fusing Artificial Intelligence (AI) with Virtual Reality (VR) to enhance skill development and personalized learning, elevating experiential learning to a new unparalleled phase. Based on the Experiential Learning Theory (ELT) and by leveraging AI's capabilities alongside VR's immersive environments in a gamified setting, this approach will address the gaps in the traditional teaching methods. Furthermore, this article investigates the role of Artificial Intelligence, Virtual Reality, and Gamification in Education separately and what are the benefits of combining the aforementioned technologies and creating a different perspective. Through a comprehensive analysis, this article highlights the transformative potential of integrating AI, VR, and gamification to redefine the educational landscape and the four-stage of Kolb's experiential learning theory.**

Keywords—Experiential learning, Gamification, Virtual Reality (VR), Artificial Intelligence (AI), Personalized Learning, Skill Development.

I. INTRODUCTION

In an era where education evolves to meet the demands of the 21st century, traditional teaching methodology seems to be deficient in engaging and effective learning experiences. The rapid growth in technology has revolutionized the field of education as it provides educators with innovative tools to enhance and empower the learning procedure at multiple levels. Technologies like Artificial Intelligence (AI), Virtual Reality (VR), Augmented Reality (AR), Gamification, Robotics, and Coding provide novel ways to engage learners, personalize learning experiences, and empower teamwork in both educators and learners [1]. These technologies are invaluable tools for the new generation of education not merely for teaching school or academic subjects but also for the development and enhancement of skills across various areas.

The traditional methodology of teaching and learning is mainly focused on stale memorization and standardized testing, which fails to cultivate and nurture critical thinking and problem-solving skills [2]. On the contrary, the usage of technology in education facilitates the educational process and promotes more interactive and adaptive learning experiences.

In today's world, it is crucial to equip students at all educational levels with skills that will serve as strong and essential tools to tackle the real -world challenges. Since each student is a unique individual with different needs, a dynamic approach to personalize learning of these skills is imperative especially when learners obtain the desirable outcome through real-life experiences.

The implementation of an approach that integrates Artificial Intelligence (AI) and Virtual Reality (VR) in a more engaging and immersive game-based environment could be the trajectory of experiential learning in future education. By combining the aforementioned tools, a multisensory learning environment is created that encourages deep understanding and the practical application of the desired skills and knowledge.

The focal points of the Experiential Learning Theory (ELT) will be coarsely presented as well as the role of each of the three core technologies in education and highlighting their synergistic potential.

II. EXPERIENTIAL LEARNING THEORY

The Experiential Learning Theory is D.A. Kolb's theory posits that learners acquire knowledge through experience. D. A. Kolb based his work on three prominent approaches of John Dewey, Kurt Lewin, and Jean Piaget. ELT emphasizes the role that experience plays in the learning process and also pursues the intellectual and emotional stimulation of the learner as it aims to integrate the mental and emotional process. "Knowledge results from the combination of

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grasping and transforming experience" [3]. His theory operates on two axes: a four-stage cycle of learning and four separate learning styles.

The first axis is a four-stage cycle :

1. Concrete Experience
2. Reflective Observation
3. Abstract Conceptualization
4. Active Experimentation.

Thus, there is a new experience of a situation or a reinterpretation of an existing experience that leads to a new experience and understanding while the reflection arouses new ideas or even the modification of an already existing abstract concept, so the learner applies them to the world around and sees the results. For instance, if a student is learning a new language, they might first immerse in a real conversation (Concrete experience), then reflect with the challenging phrases (Reflective Observation), devise strategies for improvement (Abstract Conceptualization) and finally practice again with new methods (Active Experimentation).

The second axis is a group of learning styles comprised of :

- Diverging (feeling and watching)
- Assimilating (watching and thinking)
- Converging (doing and thinking)
- Accommodating (doing and feeling)

Undeniably, in every classroom every educator will encounter learners with these learning styles and it would be ideal if there was an approach that could enclose and satisfy all of them. Educators often try a mixed methodology, incorporating digital tools and hands-on activities in order to embrace diversity and enhance inclusivity effectively.

David A. Kolb (1984), claims that “When learning is conceived as a holistic adaptive process, it provides conceptual bridges across life situations such as school and work portraying learning as continuous, lifelong process”. To understand what learning is, we must first sense the nature and the forms of human knowledge and processes whereby this knowledge is created. He conjectures that “Knowledge is the result of the transaction between social knowledge and personal knowledge”.

From an early age, we learn things and we acquire knowledge from the environment and everything that surrounds us. We never stop learning and everything that is a personal acquired experience is transforming into knowledge. In this context, it is important to note that experiential learning is not a molecular educational concept but rather is a molar concept describing the central process of human adaptation to the social and physical environment [3].

In this context, this approach emphasizes ‘learning by doing’, making it especially effective for skill-based education and personalized learning. The integration of VR, AI, and gamification seems to align with ELT while these technologies facilitate experiences and encourage reflection and adaptation. AI-driven adaptive systems can dynamically tailor learning experiences to individual needs,while VR offers immersive ,multi-sensory environments that promote experiential learning [4].

III. GAMIFICATION IN EDUCATION

Gamification is the application of game design elements in non-game context [5], exploiting the most efficient components of videogames without committing to a specific game and subsequently enhance the motivation and the engagement in the learning process [6]. The usage of Gamification has a wide range in different fields such as education, corporate training, marketing ,military and healthcare.

In Education gamification offers motivation, engagement and transforming the learning process into a fun journey. For example, platforms like Kahoot! and Duolingo are adaptive learning platforms that use algorithms to observe students’ progress and adjust the course materials accordingly [7]. Adaptive gamification AI driven provide personalized learning experiences by analysing individual preferences and consequently enhance motivation and reduce frustration.

In the field of education seems to have reshaped education providing dynamically motivation and engagement to the learners and transform the learning procedure not merely for the enjoyable and fun aspect of the process. Research on gamified classroom has demonstrated improvement in student participation and knowledge retention, particularly when competitive and cooperative elements combined. By integrating game mechanics, such as points, levels, and challenges, into educational content, gamification can transform the learning experience, making it more interactive and encourage learners to stay focused, set goals and follow their progress [8].

Moreover, case studies, such as those involving secondary education in Finland, show how gamified activities have successfully increased enthusiasm for various subjects. Particularly, a study was conducted at Finland Oman, where it was used a text-based educational video game for science lessons and it was tested on 15 fifth-grade students. As the results highlighted, playing educational games offers students additional learning assistance and increased motivation and engagement [9].

Consequently, gamification is a means which creates a sense of achievement and progress. Specifically, adaptive gamification driven by AI, may ensure that the aforementioned gaming elements can be tailored to individual learner preferences, further empower motivation, and minimize frustration.

IV. AI’S ROLE IN PERSONALISED LEARNING IN EDUCATION

AI was first coined by John McCarthy in 1956 during the Dartmouth Conference, marking a notable beginning of a revolutionary era in computing and technology. The term was used to delineate the field of study and research that aimed to create machines which can behave with intelligence. AI has evolved into a transformative tool and its application in education in 1990’s met success with the systems like Intelligent Tutoring Systems (ITS) breeding ground for personalizes experiences [10].

AI empowers personalized learning by adapting educational content and delivery methods in order to meet the unique needs of each learner. For instance platforms like

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DreamBox and Carnegie Learning analyse student's performance in real time adjusting the lessons depending on the strengths or weaknesses [11].

Moreover, the use of Artificial Intelligence (AI) in education opens up multiple simultaneous possibilities such as personalization, real time feedback, automation of repetitive tasks, analysis of learners needs and the ability to adapt to the pace and needs of each learner [4]. Thus, one of the key AI's contributions, is its capability of real-time feedback. Systems as Grammarly, GPT Zero among others assist learners to evaluate and redefine their skills instantly, providing at the same time suggestions, repetitive tasks and explanations.

Additionally, another benefit of integrating AI in education is the ability to personalize the learning procedure. Personalized learning, a cornerstone of AI in education, is a pedagogical approach that tailors instructional content, pace, and assessment to meet the specific needs of each learner [13]. This allows customized learning and adaptability that ensures that learners are entirely engaged, remain challenged and the learning outcome is optimal.

V. VIRTUAL REALITY AND IMMERSION IN EDUCATION

Immersion is the key component of the experiential learning and Virtual Reality (VR) by simulating real-world scenarios creates immersive environments. VR enables learners to practice skills in a safe and risk -free setting.

More specifically, the use of VR boosts the educational process by providing realistic visualization and interactivity in any possible setting contextually depending on the specific educational objectives/goals. Furthermore, VR can allow the observation and analysis of learners' reactions for the purpose of training them for improvement. Finally, by its nature VR is immersive, helping to enhance focus and effectiveness of learning.

Virtual Reality (VR) technology has become increasingly popular teaching and learning support tool across different disciplines [14].

VI. IMPLEMENTATION OF ADAPTIVE IMMERSIVE GAMIFICATION AI-DRIVEN VIRTUAL REALITY

The integration of AI, VR and gamification may represent the culmination of the use of technology in education. AI may analyze learner's data to personalize VR experiences, while gamified elements enhance engagement and motivation. Literature has shown the positive impacts that these adaptive and immersive technologies could have on learning when applied in gaming contexts [14]. A recent research that was conducted concerning the application of AI in VR games concluded that the intervention of AI will transform VR games due to the explicit capabilities of AI. Firstly, AI can detect and analyze the behavior of the users and change the pace of the game accordingly. Secondly, AI has the capability to improve the game strategies in real time and automatically correct the defects based on data on game players. Thirdly, AI can gather any information on the content and assist with game improvements. Finally, AI technology can develop and improve to a lightweight equipment and more convenient designs [15].

Under certain assumptions, and based on this context the combination of these adaptive and immersive technologies may lead to the rapid development of the field of education, in both learning and teaching. The transformative potential of VR, AI and gamification among others in education is a promising research field where learning is not bound by traditional learning methods but driven by creativity, teamwork and innovation [16].

VII. BENEFITS OF ADAPTIVE IMMERSIVE GAMIFICATION

Undoubtedly, the benefits of the adaptive immersive gamification in education are significant and multifaceted. By consolidating the positive impact and distinct benefits of each individual tool, we can conclude that the overarching advantages offered to education can be summarized as shows Fig 1 and as follows:

1. Personalized Learning: Personalized education fundamentally departs from the traditional one-size-fits-all approach, prioritizing the unique needs and potential of each student. Delivering meaningful, engaging lessons that resonate on an individual level, it fosters deeper connections to learning. Leveraging advanced technology, educators can craft adaptive experiences that enhance effectiveness, nurture growth, and prepare students for a lifetime of success [17].

2. Improved engagement: Gamified elements, such as leaderboards and rewards, increase student motivation. A recent study [18] emphasised the positive correlation between gamification and learner engagement. Interactive VR environments captivate learners, making education more enjoyable and impactful.

3. Risk -free skill development: Immersive technologies offer risk-free environments for skill practice. For instance, flight simulators allow aviation students to train under realistic conditions without real-world consequences. This fosters confidence and prepares learners for high-stakes scenarios [19].

4. Inclusivity: Adaptive gamification accommodates diverse learning styles and abilities. Features like customizable difficulty levels and assistive technologies ensure that all students, including those with special needs, can benefit. This aligns with UNESCO's goals for inclusive education [20].

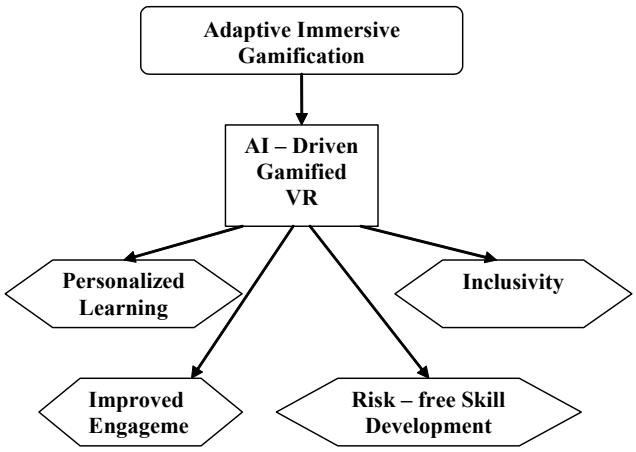

Fig 1. Adaptive Immersive Gamification

This comprehensive approach highlights the transformative potential of these technologies, underscoring their capacity

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to enhance learning experiences, foster innovation and address diverse educational needs.

VIII. Integration of Kolb's Experiential Learning Theory with AI, VR and Gamification.

The potential educational platform will leverage AI, VR and Gamification to apply in Kolb's four - stage cycle.

Concrete Experience (CE): Learners will engage in realistic, immersive activities through VR simulations, experiencing scenarios as if they were real. Gamification elements such as challenges, riddles and rewards motivate learners to fully participate.
Reflective Observation: Learners reflect on their VR experiences and AI assists by generating personalized feedback, data analysis, and guiding learners in identifying weaknesses and strengths.
Abstract Conceptualization: The platform may uses AI to provide theoretical concepts from learner's experiences and learners may have access to resources and knowledge that fit to their needs.
Active Experimentation: Learners through a gamified setting may apply their gained knowledge. VR as it was aforementioned offers a risk-free environment to act , while AI may adjust the difficulty or even context for further development.

This will be illustrated by the following flowchart in fig 2:

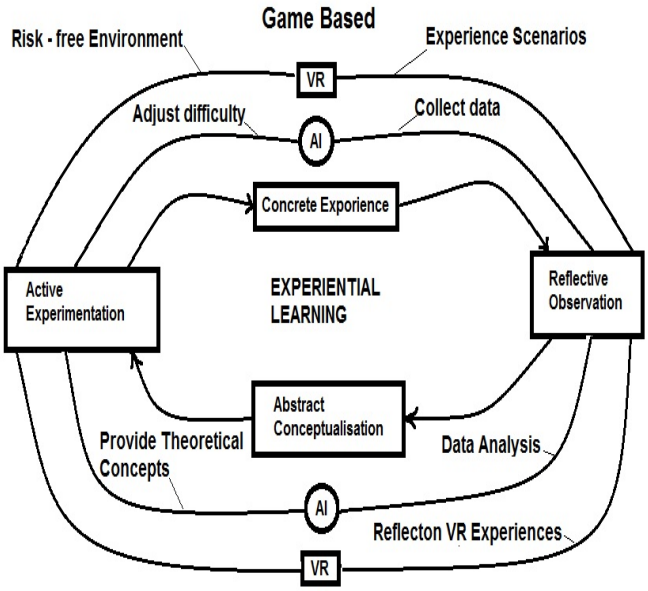

Fig 2. Experiential Learning

IX. Conclusion

Adaptive immersive gamification powered by AI and VR outlines a transformative approach to experiential learning. It redefines Experiential Learning by combining engagement, personalized learning and inclusivity and it addresses the limitations of the traditional educational methodology.
This approach not only enhances motivation and engagement but also empowers deeper learning and understanding as it offers a unique and holistic learning experience. AI-driven adaptive systems can tailor learning experiences to individual needs, while VR offers immersive multisensory environments that promote experiential learning. It empowers learners to thrive in a rapidly evolving world. Furthermore, the integration of AI and VR fosters innovation, and learners through virtual environments solve complex problems, and develop their skills and themselves.
By combining and integrating Gamification, VR and AI into Kolb's ELC, is a novel approach that redefines the experiential learning in future technological terms.
It connects the gap between theorical knowledge and practical application in skills development -among others – and provides personalized learning characteristics as well as engagement and effectiveness of the learning process. Future work will involve prototyping and evaluating a possible platform in educational environment.
Ultimately, adaptive immersive gamification leads the way for a more creative, personalized, collaborative educational future.

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